

# Boron

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The first semi-metal in the periodic table, pure boron has a slight shine to it, like a metal, but unlike metals it does not conduct electricity very well. Boron and its compounds have many uses, including in the making of detergents, LCD screens, and even tank armour.

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**ATOMIC MASS** 10.81

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**STATE** Solid

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**DISCOVERY** 1808

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(Louis-Josef Gay-Lussac and Louis-Jacques Thénard), 1808 (Sir Humphry Davy)



**Kernite, an ore of boron**



**Laboratory sample of pure boron**



Boron and carbon form boron carbide, one of the hardest known materials on the planet.